$ cat sponsorship.md

SPONSORSHIP PROSPECTUS

A one-day, in-person hackathon for the next generation of builders — high-school and early-college students who ship real projects and want partners who'll meet them where they're going.

Date	Venue	Format
June 27, 2026	Zoho Corp. Pleasanton, CA	12-hour in-person sprint

stemcalifornia@gmail.com

$ ./about

WHAT IS CSIHACKS?

CSIhacks is a high-school hackathon built around five tracks – Best Overall, Best AI/ML, Best Fintech, Best Hardware, and Best UI/UX. One day. One room. Real projects, real judges, real prizes.

100+
Expected hackers, on-site

12 hrs
Build time + judging + ceremony

5
Project tracks for prizes

WHO SHOWS UP

THE HACKERS

High-school and early-college students from across the Bay Area — self-taught coders, robotics-club kids, AoPS regulars, and first-time builders looking for a starting line.

THE MENTORS & JUDGES

Working engineers, founders, and educators rotating between teams, unsticking projects, and judging final demos. Sponsors are invited to send their own.

THE BACKERS

Run by California Stem Innovators (501(c)(3) sponsorship via Hack Club), with backing from companies like CodeCrafters, PCBWay, Featherless, Wolfram, and Tavily.

THE VIBE

Pixel art, late-night soldering, espresso, and a closing ceremony that actually feels like one. Students leave with shipped projects in their portfolio and a network they didn't have that morning.

$ ./why-sponsor

WHY SPONSOR CSIHACKS?

Hackathons are recruiting funnels, product feedback labs, and brand moments - all in one room. Sponsoring CSIhacks puts you in front of a cohort that's about to enter your hiring pipeline, your dev community, and your customer base.

1. TALENT PIPELINE

Meet ambitious high-schoolers years before they're on the market. Send recruiters, mentors, and judges; collect résumés directly.

2. REAL PRODUCT FEEDBACK

See your APIs, SDKs, and tools used by motivated developers in real time — and watch what breaks. The bug reports alone are worth it.

3. BRAND MOMENTS

Logo on-site, on the website, on shirts, in slides, on stage. Your name shows up where the hackers are paying attention.

4. COMMUNITY GOODWILL

Sponsoring student hackathons buys long-tail goodwill. The students you back today are the engineers who'll champion you in five years.

WHAT WE'LL DO FOR YOU

- **On-stage moments:** opening welcome, closing remarks, or a keynote, depending on tier.
- **Custom tracks & awards:** design a prize that maps to your product or community.
- **Tabling space:** set up a booth, demo your tools, hand out swag, run side-quests.
- **Recruitment access:** distribute materials, collect résumés, send engineers as mentors and judges.
- **Brand placement:** logo on the website, on event shirts, in the deck, in post-event recap.

THE TIERS, AT A GLANCE

Supporter	Silver	Gold	Diamond
Products, credits & services	$500	$750	$1,500
	8 slots	6 slots	4 slots

In-kind contribution

TAILORED SPONSORSHIP

Don't see a tier that fits? We're a small, founder-led team — message us and we'll design a custom package around what your team actually needs. Products, credits, services, in-kind, and cash all welcome.

$ ./commitment

COMMITMENT & INVOLVEMENT

Each tier comes with a baseline commitment and an expected level of involvement. Below is the default — we'll happily customize around what your team can give and what you want to get out of being there.

Supporter

In-kind: products, credits, or services

- Provide your product or credits to participants
- Optional: send a mentor for a session or two
- Allow us to distribute your materials at check-in
- Logo and short blurb on the event site

Silver

$500 cash or equivalent

- Send at least one judge for final demos (~1 hour)
- Optional: 1–2 engineers as mentors during the build
- Distribute swag, stickers, or recruiting materials
- 2-minute spotlight at opening or closing
- Logo on website and ceremony slides

Gold

$750 cash or equivalent

- Run a sponsor table on-site – we provide table + power
- Send 2–3 mentors and at least one judge
- Sponsor a custom award (we'll co-design with you)
- 5-minute stage moment in the closing ceremony
- Logo on website, ceremony slides, and event shirts
- Recruiting access – collect résumés on-site

Diamond

$1,500 cash or equivalent

- Title a custom project track (co-designed with us)
- Run a sponsor table on-site, all day
- Send a team of mentors plus at least one judge
- Sponsor a custom award and present it on stage
- Keynote slot at opening or closing ceremony
- Top-billed logo on site, slides, and event shirts
- Direct recruiting access (opt-in résumé share)

$ ./benefits

DETAILED BENEFITS MATRIX

Side-by-side breakdown of what each tier includes. Use this as a reference – we can mix and match if a specific row matters more than the rest.

Benefits	Supporter In-kind	Silver $500	Gold $750	Diamond $1,500
Sponsor table on-site	–	–	✓	✓
Send engineers / mentors	✓	✓	✓	✓
Send judges	–	✓	✓	✓
Distribute sponsorship materials	✓	✓	✓	✓
Custom project track	–	–	–	✓
Custom award	–	–	✓	✓
Present at opening / closing ceremony	–	**2 min**	**5 min**	**Keynote**
Logo on website & presentations	✓	✓	✓	✓
Logo on event shirts	–	–	✓	✓

NEGOTIABLE

You can always negotiate and design your own tier. Just ask – stemcalifornia@gmail.com.

$ ./next-steps

LET'S TALK

If any of this resonates, the next step is a 15-minute conversation. We move fast, paperwork is light (we run through Hack Club's fiscal sponsorship – a 501(c)(3) flow), and we'll tailor a package around what actually matters to your team.

HOW TO START

Email us with a one-liner about who you are and what you're hoping to get out of sponsoring. We'll reply with a tier recommendation and a quick scheduling link. From there: contract, invoice, and you're in.

stemcalifornia@gmail.com

QUICK FACTS

Date: June 27, 2026
Venue: Zoho, Pleasanton, CA
Org: California Stem Innovators
Fiscal sponsor: Hack Club (501(c)(3))
Web: csihacks.com

CONFIRMED SPONSORS

CodeCrafters · PCBWay · Featherless.ai · Wolfram · Tavily · Code With Purpose — and growing.

TAX & LOGISTICS

CSIhacks operates under Hack Club's 501(c)(3) fiscal sponsorship — your contribution is tax-deductible in the U.S. We can issue a receipt the same day funds clear. Wire, ACH, check, and card all welcome.

THANK YOU

Sponsoring a student hackathon isn't a transaction – it's a vote that the next generation gets to build. We don't take that lightly. See you on June 27.